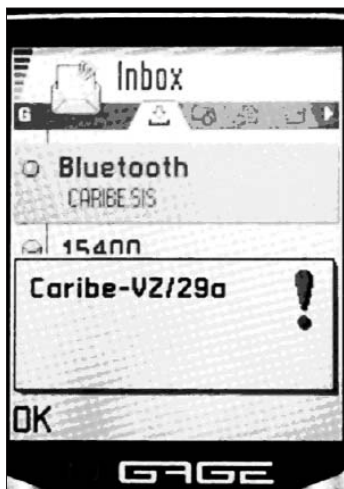


these phones that can be downloaded to your computer and installed on the phone—or even installed directly via GPRS. With the platform gaining so much popularity, it was only a matter of time before it captured virus makers' attention. Since the platform is new, people are gullible enough to download whatever upgrades they can find for their phones, and the virus scare hasn't really spread enough to make the people think twice—it's the perfect opportunity for virus makers to spread their work and gain recognition.



One of the best known viruses for series 60 phones is 'Cabir', a somewhat malicious piece of code that drains batteries and propagates itself via Bluetooth. The fact that a virus as avoidable as Cabir managed to spread amongst the masses, gives us a clue as to how gullible everyday mobile users can be. To get infected by Cabir, your phone needs to be in discoverable Bluetooth mode—visible to all nearby devices. If an infected phone tries to infect your phone, you get a note asking you to accept a message from an unknown device. If you accept, another dialog box asks if you really want to install an unverified program. Then if you click accept, you get a third dialog box that says, "Install Caribe?", which should be sufficient warning to anyone in today's day and age about malicious code. Despite three ominous warnings, people were infected, leaving us to believe that they deserved to be infected in the first place.

The success of Cabir got virus developers thinking, and today, more advanced viruses such as Skulls and METAL Gear for Symbian series 60 phones are posing a threat via Bluetooth. The good thing about Bluetooth is that at least you can reject an invitation sent by the virus; MMS on the other hand is a different ball game. With Bluetooth, viruses can only spread over short ranges,